the Indian government to optimize the balance between defense and development expenditure.

The administration knew its task to aid India was becoming harder. In Congress, there was decreasing support for foreign aid in general and aid to India in particular. At a hearing to consider his nomination as ambassador to India, Bowles insisted that aid had "allowed India to stand on her feet, succeed and stand up to Communist China." But there were questions about the effectiveness of aid. Even those like Senator Frank Carlson (R-KS), who thought India was "one country we have got to have in that area," worried about whether India could take care of itself against China even with American and British help. Senator John Sparkman (D-AL) noted that India and Pakistan's continued focus on fighting each other made it difficult to aid either of them. Senators George Smathers (D-FL) and Frank Lausche (D-OH), on their part, found it hard to justify aid toward building a nation that they considered too friendly with the Soviet Union.[73] Eventually, India did get another PL-480 commitment. But Congress appropriated only $3 billion of the administration's $4.5 billion request for FY1964. And aid allocated for India fell for a second year in a row from $400 million to $337 million.[74]

On the military assistance front, administration officials were concerned about the Indian reaction to the delays. At a meeting in late April to discuss the issue, Bowles emphasized the political rather than the military imperative to aid India, noting that India now recognized the Chinese threat, which had been the US hope for a decade. If Washington did not help, Delhi might look to make amends with Beijing or turn to Moscow. At the very least, "we should give the Indians an 'emotional assurance' as soon as possible that we are with them; this would buy us a little time." McNamara, who thought that Indian defense projections were "quite unrealistic" and the country needed a better plan, believed that the UK and US could provide anywhere from $150 million to $300 million of military assistance over three years.

Kennedy wondered if $300 million was sufficient to "get the Indians to take the same view of the [broader] Chinese threat," especially since they were thinking of military assistance of over a billion dollars. He asked, "How could we avoid a real clash and disillusionment?" The president thought the US should move on additional aid soon and not be held back by